

Provisioning Day

Tailgate to freezer. The fridge door is the finish line, and on an August quay it is one hour away.

5 °C

Chilled food at 5 °C or below when received, and held there. Eggs from a van at 7 °C or less.

1 hour

Above 32 °C, nothing sits out of refrigeration for more than one hour; two hours below that.

-18 °C

Frozen is -18 °C at every point. Shipped frozen, arrives frozen, or it stays on the quay.

STATION MAP

STATION	THE JOB	THE RULE
Quay probe point, tailgate	Probe every chilled and frozen crate before it crosses the passerelle; write the reading on the crate	5 °C or below, frozen frozen, eggs 7 °C; anything else stays on the quay and goes on the delivery note
Deck sort lane, in shade	Three lanes — freezer, fridge, dry; nothing is opened here	Nothing waits: the hour started at the tailgate
Freezer chest and upright	Freezer lane stows first; every pack dated, oldest forward	-18 °C at all points; a thawed-and-refrozen pack is refused at the quay
Fridge 1 proteins, lower shelves	Raw animal foods by species; cooked and ready-to-eat above them; fish on melting ice, drained	Raw below ready-to-eat, species apart; poultry 4 °C, minced 2 °C, fish on melting ice
Fridge 2 produce, two climates	Leaves, cole crops, berries, temperate fruit at 0–2 °C; citrus and fruit-type vegetables at 7–10 °C	Ethylene producers away from the leaves; the grouping holds for seven days
Dry store racks and the warm shelf	Tropicals, melons, hard squash, roots at 13–18 °C; dry goods dated, oldest forward	Everything 15 cm off the sole; nothing on the deck

The morning reading. Before coffee, probe the warmest shelf of every cold unit and write the probe's number in the log — not the door display's. Above 5 °C: move the contents, find the cause, write both down. Freezer at -18 °C or lower. Sign the line; the master's documented inspection reads it.

SERVICES RUN

UNITS FOUND ABOVE 5 °C AT THE MORNING READING

REFUSE ON PAPER

“This crate reads nine degrees; it goes back, and I am writing it on the note.” The reading and the refusal go on the delivery note before the driver leaves — a written 9 °C is rarely argued with, a phone call the next day always is.

LABEL RULE

Name · received · opened — three words in marker on every pack before it reaches a shelf. An opened chilled ready-to-eat item is used within seven days at 5 °C; the day of opening is day one. Thaw in the fridge at 5 °C or under running water at 21 °C or below, never on the counter.